

Servlet Versions and Types of Servlets

History of Servlet Versions:

Servlet technology has evolved over time to improve performance and features.

- **Servlet 1.0 (1997):**
First version, basic support for handling requests and responses.
- **Servlet 2.0 (1998):**
Added session management and better lifecycle control.
- **Servlet 2.1 (1999):**
Improved portability and web application support.
- **Servlet 2.2 (1999):**
Introduced web application structure and deployment descriptor (web.xml).
- **Servlet 2.3 (2001):**
Added filters and event listeners.
- **Servlet 2.4 (2003):**
Improved XML configuration and expression language support.
- **Servlet 2.5 (2005):**
Simplified configuration, no major new features.
- **Servlet 3.0 (2009):**
Introduced annotations, asynchronous processing.
- **Servlet 3.1 (2013):**
Non-blocking I/O support.
- **Servlet 4.0 (2017):**
HTTP/2 support.

Types of Servlets:

There are two main types of servlets:

1. Generic Servlet

- It is a protocol-independent servlet.
- Belongs to javax.servlet package.
- Used for any type of request (not only HTTP).
- Defines a service() method to handle requests.
- Less commonly used.

Features:

- Platform independent
- Can handle different protocols
- Simpler but less powerful for web apps

2. HTTP Servlet

- Extends Generic Servlet
- Belongs to javax.servlet.http package
- Designed specifically for HTTP protocol
- Most commonly used servlet

Methods:

- doGet() – Handles GET requests
- doPost() – Handles POST requests
- doPut(), doDelete() – Other HTTP methods

Features:

- Supports HTTP-specific functions
- Easy to build web applications
- More powerful and widely used